

GIF stickers to choose from, options for slow motion and time lapse, and a whole bunch of lighting tweaks. The app is also smooth, does not have a glitchy interface, and is the best designed app on this list.

Mitron

Mitron for some reason has a user interface that mimics Netflix, and has a wide variety of content, similar to what you could see on TikTok. This is video platform with endless scrolling, with content organised into four bins. The major problem with the app is just that the videos do not show up, and you might just be scrolling through blank space. The load times for the videos are a little longer, as the app seems to load the entire video even when showing the thumbnails. The scrolling is slow, and the videos do not show up instantly even on fast internet connections. So this is very much a spotty user experience. While browsing the videos can be something of a pain, the editing part is surprisingly well done. This part of the application is smooth, is not glitchy, and is pretty powerful at the same time. The video editing features are just right for what you would expect from the app. overlay captions, emojis and stickers. There are options to chop the videos down to size, a bunch of filters, the ability to slap on stickers or captions, and a slow motion effect. You can also add a custom background sound to the videos before uploading. Although the official website does not contain a link to the App Store, the app is actually available on both major platforms.

ShareChat

The USP of ShareChat is that it is completely dedicated to localisation, with the app available in Haryanvi, Rajasthani, Bhojpuri, Assamese and Urdu apart from the ten languages that the other apps are available in. There is no English version at all. This is not a primarily video app, and includes all kinds of content, including images and even sound clips. There are channels that get shuffled around keeping up with the times, for example, there is one right now dedicated to the ongoing pandemic. There is also a news channel, and even one dedicated to WhatsApp forwards. There is a video channel for just videos, and understandable the content is thoroughly local. There are absolutely

no video editing features though. This is about as barebones as it gets, but still there is a wealth of content. Users can download videos for offline viewing, and share all the content directly through WhatsApp. The great thing about the app is that it works just as well on web browsers as on smartphones, so you really don't have to install the app at all.

FILE MANAGEMENT

Shareit and Xender, two file transfer apps were also among the apps that were banned. While the urls for these apps are not working any longer, and the cloud services are also down, for the local sharing and management features, the apps continue to work if they have already been installed. For iOS users, Xender is still available on the App Store; at the time of writing. The most useful features of these apps is the ability to transfer files between smartphones, between the phones and computers or back up the files on the cloud. Considering the restrictions on Apple devices, and the containment of apps, most of the alternatives for these file managers are not even available on the App Store. However, Android users have a choice of alternatives. The main options to replace Xender or Shareit are Dropbox, JioSwitch, Files by Google and Shareall.

Dropbox

Dropbox is essentially a cloud storage manager, that is similar to Google Drive. The subscription plans for additional storage is economical, with 2TB available for ₹969 a month whereas the same amount of storage on Google Drive costs ₹1,300 a month. Dropbox allows you to free up space on your devices by uploading files to the cloud. The links to the files on the cloud can be shared with others through links. It is possible to share a single file or folder, and additionally password protect the access. There are some very thoughtful features in Dropbox, such as an inbuilt feature to scan documents, and the ability to automatically send photos clicked on the device to a computer that is connected to the internet. The app also allows you to save voice memos or photos directly to the cloud as well. This is extremely convenient as several steps are automatically skipped in the process of sending content from the phone to the

desktop. The app works on both iOS and Android. For those who use Dropbox primarily from their computers, the mobile app allows you to share files on the go, change permissions, and even manage the files in the cloud storage. The main feature lacking in Dropbox is the ability to send files from one device to another directly, without an internet connection.

JioSwitch

JioSwitch is a fast and easy to use application that allows you to send and receive files between two smartphones. The app automatically detects the files on the device and allows you to select multiple files before sending, and also gives you an estimate of the transfer time. One of the advantages of JioSwitch is that it allows users to send files from an iOS device to an Android device, with an additional step of using the iOS device for connecting to a WiFi hotspot created by the Android device. While JioSwitch is very good for transferring files between devices, it has no cloud storage functionality, and does not allow you to transfer files between a smartphone and a computer. Nevertheless, the UI is very simple, and the app is good at what it does.

Files

Formerly known as Files Go, Files by Google is a storage manager that is primarily used for clearing up memory on the device, quickly deleting junk files, and getting rid of duplicates. The application integrates deeply with the Android OS, and gives smart recommendations such as deleting apps that you do not use, or getting rid of temp files that are affecting the performance of the device. You can also quickly clear up the phone memory by transferring all files to an SD card.

Files also has the features that you would expect from a file sharing app, and as long as another person has the app installed on their device as well, any type of file can be transferred between the two smartphones. Files allows you to backup files on Google Drive, but also supports third party cloud storage providers.

Share All

Share All is a basic file sharing app with a very low system footprint of less than 8 MB. It allows you to quickly share files between devices without an internet